

1949, August 9.

The following is a faithful transcription of a typed original by the
Servant of God, Father Solanus Casey, O.F.M. Cap.

August 9 -49

ST FELIX FRIARY
Route 8
Huntington, Indiana

Blessed be God in all
and each of His designs.

God bless you Granma Kauffman: you and yours.
But what is this we hear of you? Brother Leo and Mrs.
Whitman, Norma, tells us you have been not at all well;
and that you are in the hospital. I kinda wondered
when reading this, if you were following my bad ex-
ample. Well in that case, I hope you will have fol-
lowed the good part too and get well in short notice.

Four of us drove over to Milwaukee for the Unveiling
of the big statue of Father Stephen, with whom I worked when first
ordained and for several years off and on. Well, there were a
couple dozen affected by ptomane-poison and, according as one looks
at difficulties and crosses, I was one of the dozens of unfortunate
or would rather say fortunate ones. It was surely to nature a
very unpleasant experience; but thanks be to God! I feel that my
soul profited greatly by the experience of about a month in hospi-
tal, -in Saint Michael's Milwaukee and St. Josephs, Ft. Wayne.

It was a "bitter pill that turned to sweetness of soul and body",
as St. Francis tells us in the holy Rule, about his personal ex-
periences with the poor, dear lepers of his day, and as many
chaplains and soldiers tell of what they went through in the 2nd
World War".

Now dear Mrs. Kauffman: I hope you are turning this
breaking of life's monotony - all unpleasant as such experiences
are to nature, - into sacrifices of great merit. This you can do
by thinking on the sufferings and Passion of our dear Lord and
offering your sufferings in union with those He suffered for all
us poor sinners that in His infinite condescension deigns to call
us His brethren. And more than this, that it may be no empty title
and as a last bequest, gives us His own blessed Virgin Mother to
be our dear, gentle Mother too. !!! Incidentally there is something
wherein you could do me and my dear Guardian Angel a real favor;...
Offer something of your restlessness for God's blessing on a pro-
ject I - let me venture to say, we - have been working on for many
months. If we put it over, as with divine assistance we hope to do,
it will mean much toward the true peace of billions. Deo gratias!
Pray too, that God's Holy Spirit guide the deliberations of our fathers
in the coming Chapter in Nov.

Sincerely in the Sacred Hearts of Jesus and Mary. Fr. Solanus

Original in possession of:

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